

AIDS

HIV is a virus that weakens the body's defences. AIDS is the late stage if HIV is not treated. With treatment, people with HIV can stay healthy for many years.

For community members

Key messages

- HIV spreads through unprotected sex, through blood (shared needles, razors or unsafe blood), and from a mother to her baby during pregnancy, birth or breastfeeding.
- HIV does not spread by hugging, sharing food or plates, using the same toilet, or mosquito bites.
- You can get tested at the health centre. Knowing your status lets you protect yourself and your family.
- Treatment is available. Taking it every day keeps the virus under control.

- A pregnant woman who is tested and takes treatment can protect her baby.
- Using condoms and staying with one faithful, tested partner lowers the risk. Never share needles or razors.
- Do not shame or shut out people with HIV. Support them to stay on treatment.

Think about getting tested if

- You have had sex without a condom or with more than one partner
- You have TB
- You are pregnant
- Your partner has tested positive
- You have had a long fever, diarrhoea or weight loss with no clear reason

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.